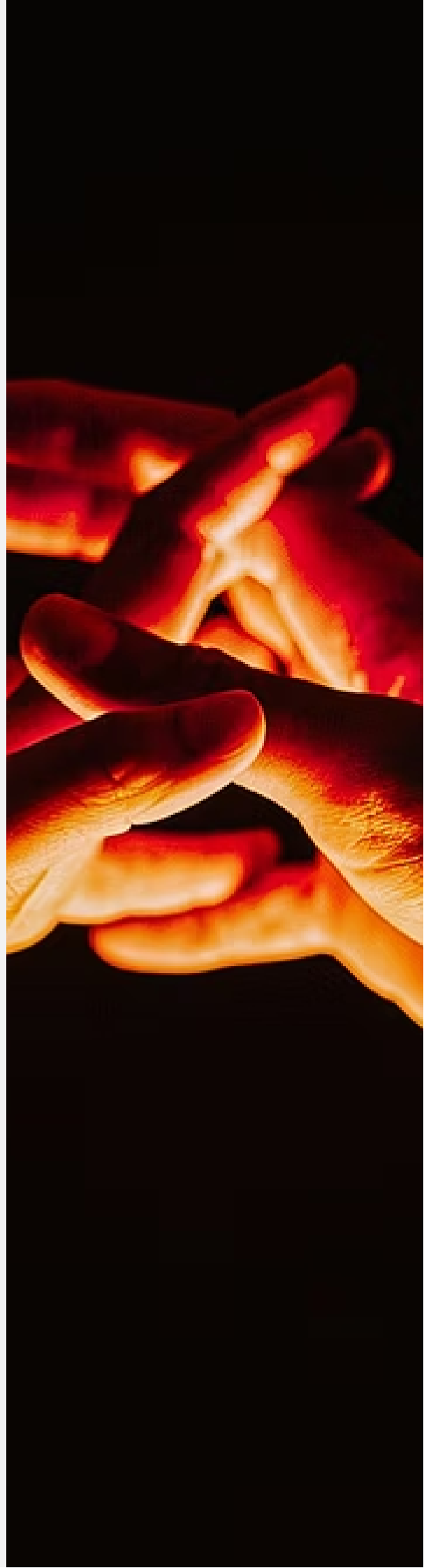


10 TOUCH RITUALS

*FOR COUPLES WHO LOVE
EACH OTHER AND WANT
TO FEEL IT AGAIN.*

BY JULIETTE KARAMAN
— CREATOR OF THE
BEGINNING: THE
ULTIMATE TOUCH RESET





A NOTE BEFORE YOU BEGIN

THE TRUTH ABOUT COUPLES

Most couples don't fall out of love.

They fall out of **touch**.

Not just physical touch - though that too. They lose the habit of landing in each other's presence. The body forgets what it felt like to be reached for, to be held without agenda, to feel genuinely met.

What These Rituals Are For

These 10 rituals are not about fixing what's broken. They are about **remembering what's already there**.

Use them in order. Use them out of order. Use one for a week. Use all of them in a month.

What matters is this: you show up, you slow down, and you let yourself be felt.

WHY TOUCH MATTERS

The skin is the largest organ in your body.

It contains more nerve endings than anything else. Before you had words, before you could recognise faces, touch was how you knew you were safe.

It is the first language you ever learned.

When physical touch is absent, the nervous system registers it. Through the slow drift of busy lives, through bodies that forget to reach. The nervous system starts to call the distance normal.

Gradually, the body stops expecting to be met. That is what I call going quiet.

Touch regulates the nervous system. It releases oxytocin, serotonin, dopamine. It reduces cortisol.

It tells your body: you are not alone. You are not a threat to each other. You can soften here.

In 15 years working with over 650 couples, what I see most is this: their bodies have stopped speaking to each other.

These 10 rituals are a way back into that conversation.

"Most people think that kind of touch is luck, or chemistry. It is not. We built it. What you are watching is the result. These ten rituals are where it gets built."



THE TRACE RITUAL

THE VIDEO PEOPLE FIND ME THROUGH IS ONE MOMENT OF THIS. HE TRACES MY JAW WITH HIS FINGERTIPS, SLOWLY, AND I RECEIVE IT.

What you cannot see is everything underneath.



NO PERFORMANCE.

That kind of touch only lands because two things are true at once.

One person knows how to receive without flinching, managing, or turning it into something that has to go somewhere. The other slows down enough to give it — fully present, wanting nothing back.

Almost nobody is taught either one. This ritual teaches both.

Follow along with the video as I narrate what to do:

Follow along

STEP 1 — ASK FIRST

Can I trace your face for two minutes? No agenda. Nothing needs to happen after this.

STEP 2 — AGREE THE CONTAINER

Two minutes. The receiver does nothing but feel. The giver does nothing but give. This is not going toward anything else. That is what makes it safe.

STEP 3 — RECEIVE

Close your eyes. Soften your jaw. Let your hands rest. Your only job is to feel the touch land, and to stay with it when the urge comes to smile it off or hurry it along. Notice that urge. Let it pass.

STEP 4 — GIVE

Start at the temple or the edge of the jaw. The lightest contact, fingertips or the edge of a nail, slower than you think slow is. Like honey. Watch where the breath changes. Follow that.

STEP 5 — ONE WORD

When the two minutes end, the receiver says one word for what they felt. Not an explanation. A word. The giver receives it by saying thank you. Switch if you both want to.

Notice: receiver, where did you want to speed it up or make it mean something? Giver, what happened in you when you slowed down and were not reaching for anything more?

Why it works:

Receiving is a skill, and most bodies have lost it. When you are touched with no demand attached, your nervous system gets to learn that closeness is not a transaction.

The giver learns the same thing from the other side.

This is touch that lands because nothing is being chased. It is the whole method in two minutes.



RITUAL 1 — THE LANDING

Most couples start the day already managing it. Phones, children, logistics, the mental list. The bodies in the same room never actually arrive into the same room.

This takes 90 seconds.

O1

Before phones. Before speaking. Before the day begins.

O2

Find each other. Stand or sit close enough to feel each other's warmth.

O3

Look at each other, take a breath in through your nose and exhale through your mouth.

O4

Do this 3 times together and watch what happens between you.

O5

One of you says: "I'm here."

O6

The other one receives that and says: "I feel you."

O7

Notice what happens in your bodies as you witness each other.

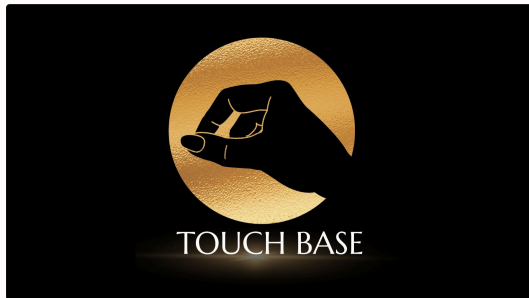
O8

Nothing else is required.

One says: "I'm here." The other: "I feel you."

This is a practice of arrival, not performance.

RITUAL 2 — TOUCH BASE® ANCHOR



I teach this to every single client. It is the foundation of everything else in this document.

Your body is always scanning. Asking: -

All it takes is one loaded moment. A look. A brush. A hand that lingered where it shouldn't have. Your system registers it. You might not remember when. But your body does. It braces.

Often, even in loving relationships, this is why touch doesn't land. Not because you don't want to receive it. Because your body is still armoured, just in case.

Touch Base® interrupts that loop. Without drama. Without excavation.

O1

Press your thumb to your forefinger.

O2

Slowly move your top finger so you can feel every single finger ridge.

O3

Slower than you think slow is. Like honey. Even slower than that.

O4

Notice where you want to speed up. Notice what thoughts are coming up. Let them pass.

O5

Remind yourself: there is no tiger in the room. I am safe.

O6

Do this for 2 minutes.

Twice a day. Morning and evening. 2 minutes each time.

Notice: Before you begin, rate how you feel 1–10. After 2 minutes, rate again. What shifted?

Why it works: this gesture activates pressure points that, when paired with slowness, breath, and attention, down-regulate the stress response.

You are gently retraining your system to associate this moment with safety. After 31 days it becomes automatic. After 90 it is muscle memory.

You will find yourself doing it when a car cuts in front of you, when the children are pushing every button, when you feel yourself drifting from the present moment. So discreet your partner won't even notice. But your body will.

[Watch the video](#)

RITUAL 3 — THE NAME

Say their name. The actual name they were given.

Not love, not babe, not darling. Their name, with your full attention behind it.

O1

At any moment in the day, turn to face them.

O2

Say their name. Once. Slowly. With presence.

O3

Nothing else is required.

Notice: what changes in them when you do this? What changes in you?

When we say someone's name with presence, it lands differently.

It says: I see you specifically. Not the role you are playing. Not the version of you I have grown used to.

You, as you actually are, right now.

EXTRA PRACTICE

Play with how you say each other's names:

→ Surprised

→ Angry

→ Playful

→ Longingly

→ Hesitantly

Notice how it feels to receive this from your partner.

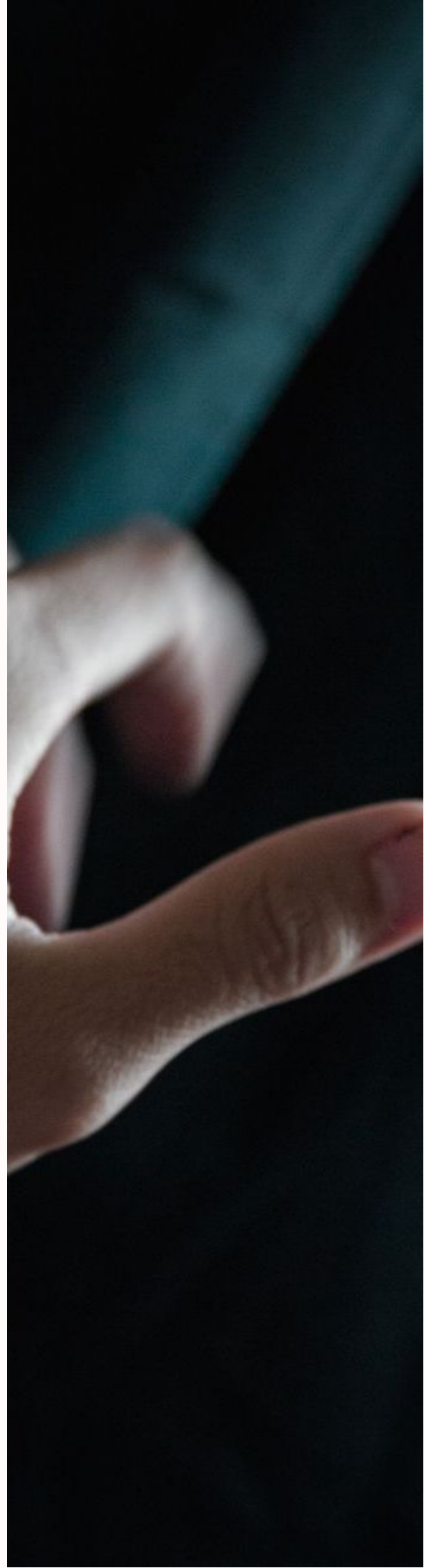
Notice how it felt to do this exercise in all its forms.

Which did you prefer?

What didn't you like?

Bringing awareness to these patterns is Key.

→ Listen along as I do this exercise



RITUAL 4 — THE HANDSHAKE OF GRATITUDE

Before sleep, each person names one physical moment from the day where they felt close.

Not 'you were kind.' Something sensory, specific. The way they reached for your hand. The moment they turned toward you in the kitchen. The 30 seconds they stopped what they were doing and looked at you.

O1

Lie or sit together before sleep.

O2

One of you names one physical moment from the day. Sensory. Specific.

For Example: There was a moment when you reached for me in the kitchen and my lower back tightened slightly. I felt you pull away slightly.

O3

The other receives it. "Thank you" Just: received.

O4

Switch.

Notice: what does it feel like to be named specifically?

What does it feel like to search for that moment in your own memory?

Why it works: specificity teaches the body what to reach for more of.

When you name a physical moment, you are training your nervous system to register closeness when it happens, not just in retrospect.

Over time, you stop missing each other while you are still in the room.

Listen along to my example

RITUAL 5 — THE THREE BREATH HOLD

When one of you is overwhelmed, the most common response is to try to help. To fix. To say the right thing.

Sometimes the body just needs to know it is not alone.

O1

When one of you is overwhelmed, reach for their hand.

O2

Don't speak.

O3

Take three slow breaths together. In through the nose, out through the mouth.

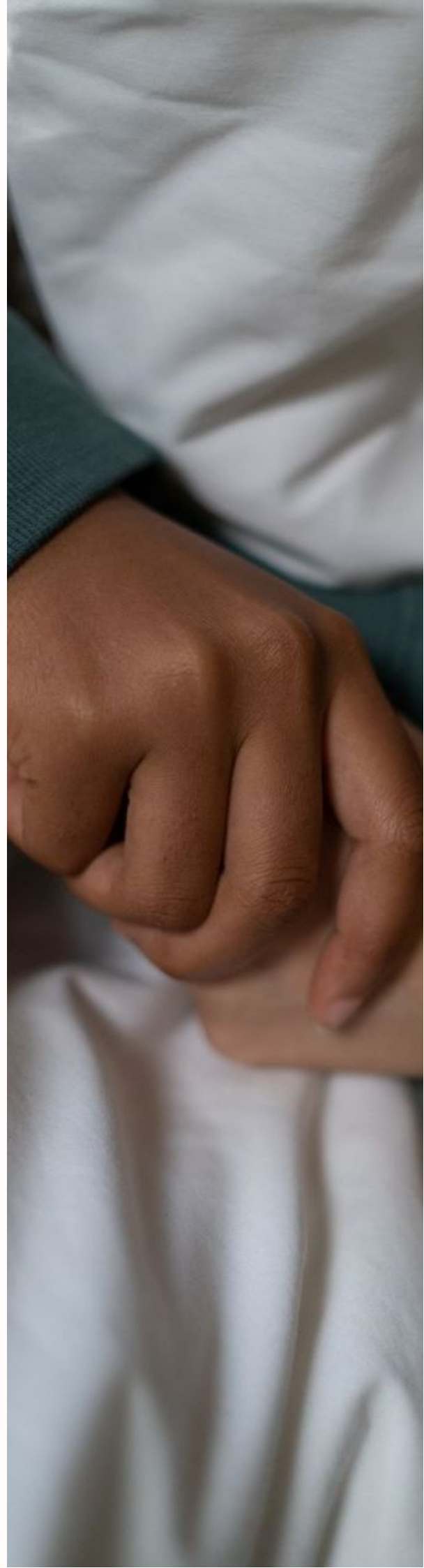
O4

That is all.

Notice: what does it feel like to be held in silence rather than solved?

This is presence, not a solution.

It says: I am staying. That is sometimes everything.



RITUAL 6 — THE 60-SECOND HUG

I teach structured touch. That means time. That means agreement. That means following through. All of it creates safety.

Some people think it is crazy to start with a 60-second hug. Until they do it this way.

O1

Step 1 — Ask first

"Do you have the bandwidth for this?"

O2

Step 2 — Agree the container

60 seconds. No talking. No phones. No distractions. This is not going to lead anywhere else. That last part matters. Safety means the body knows what it signed up for.

O3

Step 3 — Arrive

Look at each other's eyes as you reach for them. Let your body guide how much you want to lean in. Take one breath together, in through the nose, out through the mouth.

O4

Step 4 — Hold

Allow yourself to be held. Allow yourself to hold. No agenda.

Notice: is your breath starting to synchronise with theirs? Can you feel their heartbeat?

Afterwards: rate on a scale of 1–10 how connected you feel. 1 is completely disconnected. 10 is fully met.

Why it works: at 20 seconds oxytocin begins to release. Cortisol drops. The nervous system stops scanning and starts to settle. Your body registers what your mind already knows: you are safe here.

The agreed time is not a limit. It is a container. When both bodies know when it will end, they can fully arrive into it.





RITUAL 7 — THE 3-MINUTE TOUCH RESET

Most people wait until they feel ready for a Touch Date. The body doesn't work that way. You don't feel ready and then touch.

You touch, and readiness arrives.

A TOUCH DATE DOES NOT NEED TO BE AN HOUR. IT NEEDS TO BE PRESENT.

Three minutes, structured, with agreement.

O1

Step 1 — Ask first

"Do you have three minutes? No agenda. Nothing needs to happen after this."

O2

Step 2 — Arrive

Sit facing each other. Both press thumb to forefinger. Touch Base®. Close your eyes. One breath together, in through the nose, out through the mouth. Let the day fall away.

O3

Step 3 — One Touch

Partner A places their palm gently on Partner B's hand. No movement. No agenda. The weight of a hand that says: I'm here. Partner B receives it. Eyes can stay closed.

O4

Step 4 — One word

When the minute ends, Partner B says one word for what they felt. Not an explanation. A word.

Partner A receives it by saying 'thank you'. Switch.

Partner B places their palm, Partner A receives. Close together with Touch Base®.

Notice: what was present in your body at the start that is different now? Where did you feel the contact land?

The full Touch Date sequence, the structured arcs from 3 to 20 minutes and the complete Yes/No/Maybe Touch Menu, is inside the Ultimate Touch Reset.

RITUAL 8 — THE BREATH BRIDGE

Once a month. No touch required. Just presence and breath.

Most couples underestimate how much the body communicates before any touch begins. This practice teaches you to feel each other's nervous system and let yours respond.

01

Step 1 — Ask first

"Can we do 3 minutes together? Just breathing. Nothing else."

02

Step 2 — Sit facing each other

Close enough to feel each other's warmth. Knees touching or not, let your body choose.

03

Step 3 — Breathe together

Inhale through the nose, 4 counts. Hold, 2 counts. Exhale through the mouth, 6 counts. Let it become rhythmic. 3 minutes.

04

Step 4 — Notice

Is your breath starting to sync with theirs?

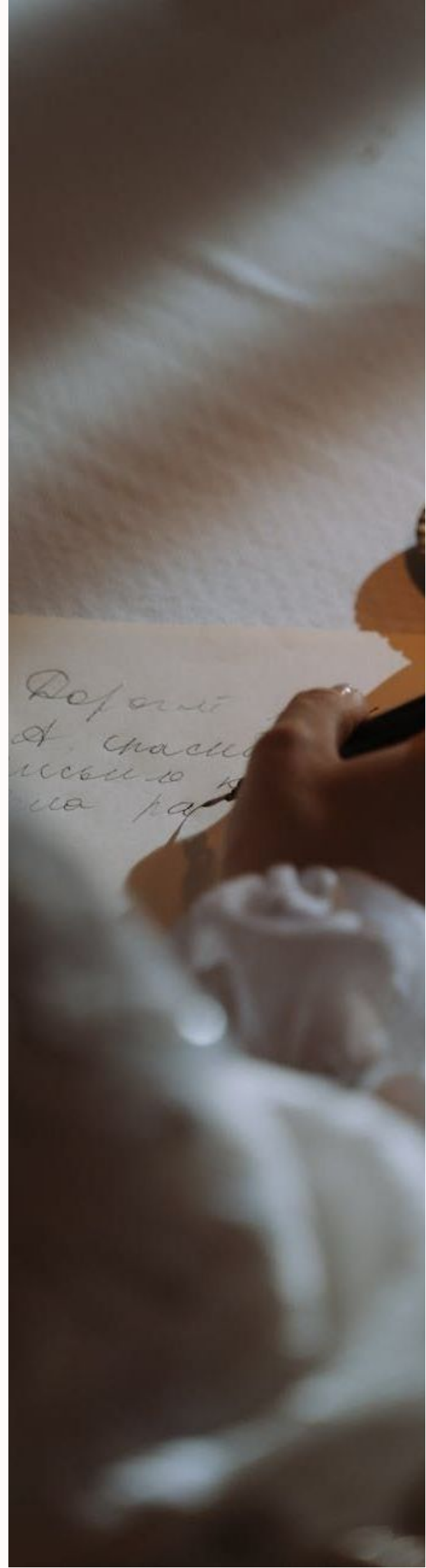
Does anything soften in your chest, your jaw, your hands?

What is the quality of the space between you now compared to when you started?

Afterwards: each of you shares one word for what you felt. No discussion. Just receive it.

Why it works: synchronised breath co-regulates two nervous systems. You are not just relaxing individually. You are coming into the same frequency. The body reads that as: we are safe together.

You have done something intimate without a single touch.



A photograph of two men in a room. One man is standing, wearing a dark t-shirt and dark pants, and the other is sitting on a low stool or chair, wearing a blue patterned shirt and dark pants. They are both looking down at something in the man's hands. The room has a white wall with an arched doorway in the background and a wooden floor.

RITUAL 9 — THE APPROACH

Do this when the distance has grown without either of you naming it. Or once a year as a reset.

This practice reveals something most couples have never consciously noticed: what happens in your body when the person you love actually moves toward you. Do you open? Do you brace? Do you lean in, or hold back without realising it?

O1

Step 1 — Agree the container

"I am going to walk toward you slowly. You tell me when to stop, when the distance feels right to you. There is no wrong answer."

O2

Step 2 — Partner A stands still

"Feet grounded. Eyes open. Notice what arises as they approach. You do not need to do anything except feel."

O3

Step 3 — Partner B walks toward them

"One slow step at a time. Pause between each step. Let the space between you change gradually."

O4

Step 4 — Partner A signals stop

"A raised hand. A word. When the distance feels right: not too close, not too far. Exactly as your body wants it."

O5

Step 5 — Both notice

"What happened in your body as they approached?"

Was there a moment you wanted to open toward them? A moment you wanted them to pause?

Where did you feel it?

Switch roles. Repeat."

Afterwards, one prompt each using the Dyad:

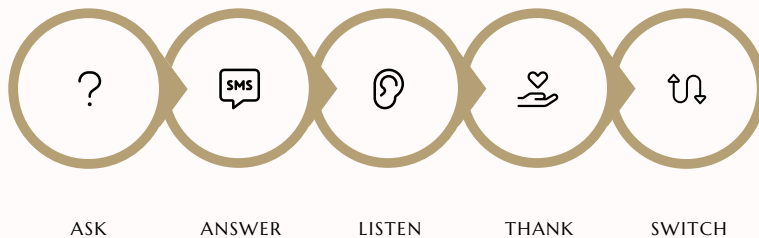
Tell me what happened in your body as I moved toward you.

This is one practice from the full Yes/No/Maybe Touch Menu inside The Touch Reset Program: where you map your body's response to touch across four categories, from energetic presence through to full sensation.

THE DYAD

A structured communication practice for couples who want to go beyond "I'm fine."

Most couples don't struggle to talk. They struggle to listen - really listen - without preparing their response, without defending, without the conversation becoming a negotiation. The Dyad method removes that pressure.



After years of being with couples in session, I noticed that the hardest thing was rarely the touching. It was finding the words.

Not because people didn't have them. Because they didn't have a structure safe enough to say them in.

I created the Intimacy and Communication Cards because couples needed something they could use without me in the room.

A way to keep the conversation alive between sessions, between weeks, in the ordinary moments that matter.

15 minutes of being genuinely heard and **understood** does more for relationship than three hours of debate.

One question at a time.

How it works:

1. One person reads the prompt.
2. The other answers, honestly, without editing. ONE thought at the time only.
3. The listener stays present. No fixing, no defending, no responding.
4. When the answer lands: say **"Thank you."**
5. If you need clarity: say **"Clarify that."**
6. If too many thoughts or too long: **"Summarise that."**
7. Switch.
8. Continue on with one prompt at least 5 times, ideally 15 minutes.

This is where the gold is. At first the answers may be surface swimming but the more you repeat the same prompt, the deeper you will go.

A few of the couples who have been together for over 3 decades were surprised how much this brought up for them and how they learned things about their partner they had not known.



RITUAL 10: USING THE PROMPTS



TOUCH & SENSATION

- Tell me what kind of touch makes you feel most present.
- Tell me something about your body you wish I understood.
- Tell me what it feels like in your body when you reach for me first.



PRESENCE & DISTANCE

- Tell me when you feel closest to me, without any effort.
- Tell me when you feel furthest from me, even when we're in the same room.
- Tell me what you need from me when you're pulling away.



DESIRE & LONGING

- Tell me something you love about me that you haven't said recently.
- Tell me something you've stopped asking for.
- Tell me what you long for that we haven't found a way to have yet.



TRUST & REPAIR

- Tell me something that hasn't fully healed between us.
- Tell me when you feel most trusting of me.
- Tell me what repair feels like in your body when it actually happens.



BECOMING

- Tell me who you are right now that I may not fully know yet.
- Tell me what kind of couple you want us to be.
- Tell me one thing you want us to do this year that you have not spoken out loud.

THE INTIMACY & COMMUNICATION CARDS

475 PROMPTS. ONE PRACTICE.

Four decks:

The Couples Edition, The Family and Friends Edition, The Touch Languages, and Trust & Repair: a 50-card deck for couples navigating a rupture, a distance, or a moment they can't seem to move past.

Available as an **app** (so it lives in your pocket, always ready for a quiet evening or moment of connection) and as a **physical deck**.

Every prompt is designed to open something without forcing it.

The cards work in the same structure as The Dyad. One person picks a card and reads it out loud.

The other person answers from the heart.

One answer per turn. The listener responds with only three things: Thank you. Clarify that. Summarise that.

Switch and go deeper with each turn.

[Get the Cards →](#)

WHAT THE CARDS COVER

EMOTIONAL INTIMACY

Questions that reach beneath the surface of daily life.

PHYSICAL SENSATION

Prompts that reconnect you to your body and your partner's.

DESIRE & PLAY

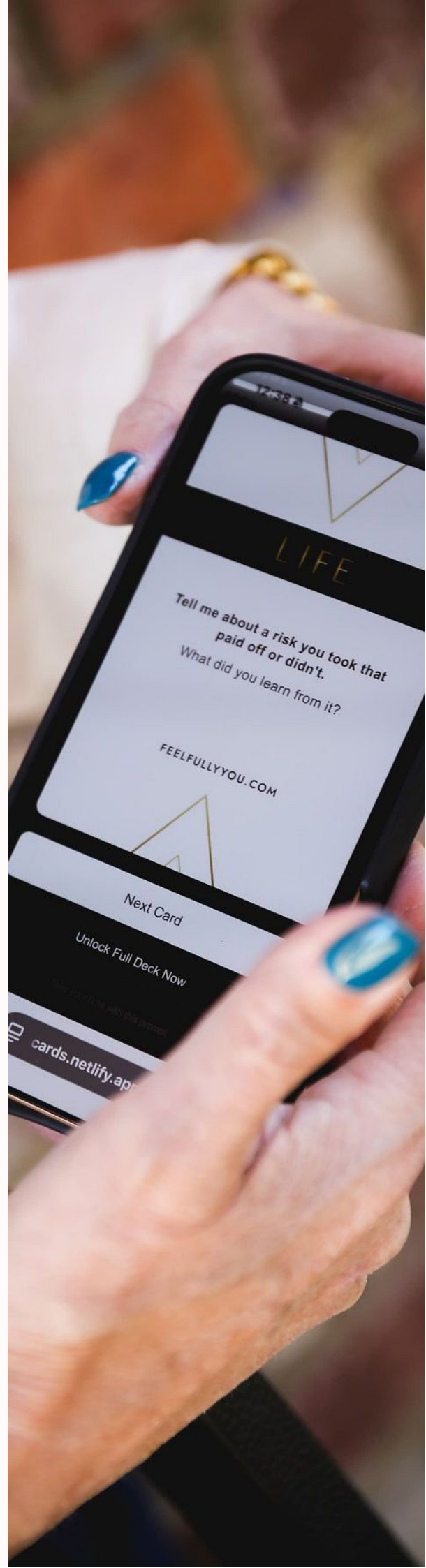
Invitations to explore what you want and what delights you.

TRUST & REPAIR

50 dedicated prompts for navigating rupture and distance.

FAMILY & FRIENDS

150 prompts to get to know your family and friends in a much deeper way, and to be understood.



MEET JULIETTE

27 YEARS OF HELPING PEOPLE FEEL, RELATE, AND CONNECT.



I create experiences: for the moment you understand exactly what's happening in your body, and still something tightens or fades the second closeness begins.

For over 27 years I've worked with how people feel, relate, and connect: across mind, nervous system, body, and relationship.

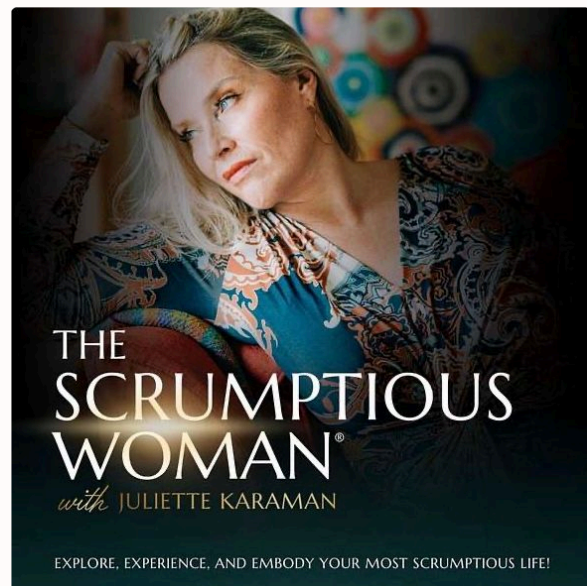
It began with children on the autism spectrum, helping them trust sensation before they had words for it. For the last fifteen, I've worked with thousands of individuals and couples who love each other, live full lives, and still lose connection the moment touch begins.

Insight alone doesn't change intimacy. Touch alone doesn't either. **Change happens through experiences the body can stay present with.**

The couples I work with don't just understand themselves better — they feel different, they touch differently, they stay in connection.

THE SCRUMPTIOUS WOMAN PODCAST:
TOP 2.5% WORLDWIDE

[Listen here](#)

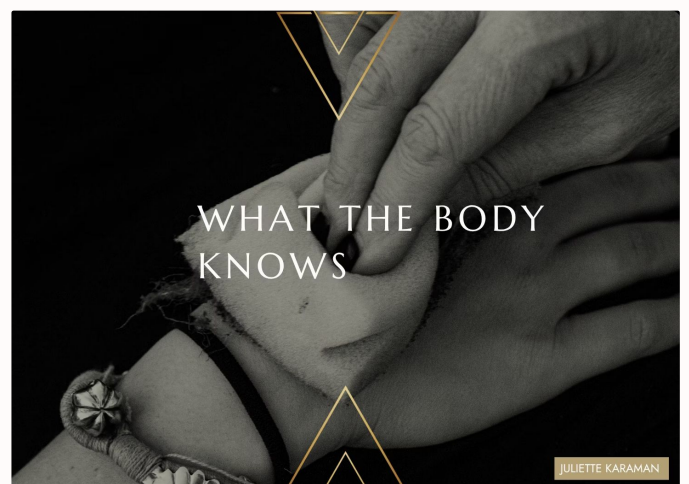


WHEN THE BODY KNOWS: SUBSTACK

I write more deeply on Substack. Why these processes work, what I have seen and what the journey has been.

If you are interested in this follow me there.

[Follow here](#)



YOUR NEXT YES

This wasn't just a guide. It was your first soft yes: a yes to clarity, to being heard before you speak, to the kind of touch that doesn't perform: **it lands.**

ONE TOUCH

7 Days. Your own hands. Entirely private.

You have the ten rituals now. They bring touch back into the room. One Touch is where you go underneath them.

Seven days. Your own hands. Entirely private.

Where you learn to feel your own Touch Pattern in your body before you ask anyone else to meet it. If you cannot yet read your own body, you cannot read what is happening between you and someone else. This is where that literacy begins.

You show up for yourself first. Everything else follows.



→ **One Touch**